



PANTRY-FIRST MEAL PLANNING

Dinner starts with what you have.

Your pantry, recipes and grocery list.
Finally working as one kitchen.

Product strategy / UX concept / Interactive prototype

A LITTLE HELP WITH TONIGHT

"Use my tomatoes.
Keep it easy."

A GOOD FIT FOR YOUR KITCHEN

Tomato & lentil skillet

25 min / 2 servings / 1 pan

Uses your garden tomatoes.
One missing ingredient goes on the list.

PANTRY → RECIPE → GROCERY LIST

Not more recipes. Better answers.

The opportunity is to turn kitchen context into a meal someone can actually make.

"What makes sense to cook next?"

A useful answer knows the food, the people, and the moment.

DESIGN HYPOTHESIS — TO VALIDATE

Start with busy households that want to cook at home, but do not want meal planning to become another job.

01

What is already here?

Food is scattered across cupboards, the fridge, the freezer, and the week's garden harvest.

02

What fits real life?

Time, tools, tastes and energy change from one evening to the next.

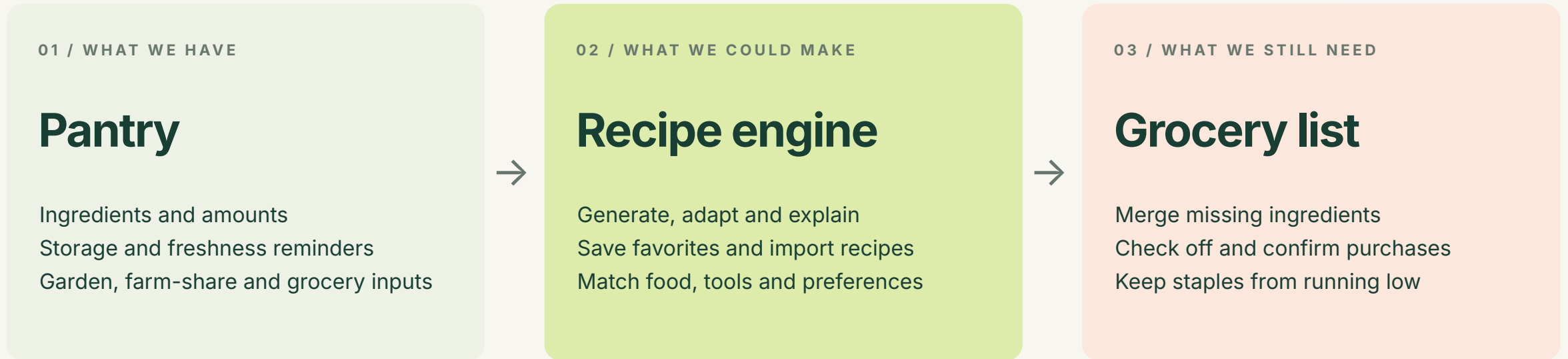
03

What needs to happen next?

A recipe becomes useful only when shopping, preparation and inventory stay connected.

Three modules. One connected loop.

The meal plan is a shared workspace across the modules—not a disconnected fourth database.



MEAL PLAN

Choose → Reserve → Shop → Cook → Reconcile

Shared foundation: household preferences, equipment, ingredient identities, quantities, and a reversible action history.

From “What’s for dinner?” to a closed loop.

A concrete example: tomatoes from the garden, dinner for two, one missing ingredient.

PANTRY

01

Bring food in

Add 800 g of garden tomatoes.
Mark them “use soon.”

RECIPES

02

Find a good fit

Ask for an easy dinner.
See a skillet recipe and why it fits.

MEAL PLAN

03

Make a plan

Accept Monday’s meal.
Reserve 400 g; leave stock unchanged.

GROCERY LIST

04

Fill the gap

Need 100 g of spinach.
One combined grocery line appears.

PANTRY

05

Confirm what came home

Buy a 200 g bag.
Put-away confirmation adds 200 g.

CLOSE THE LOOP

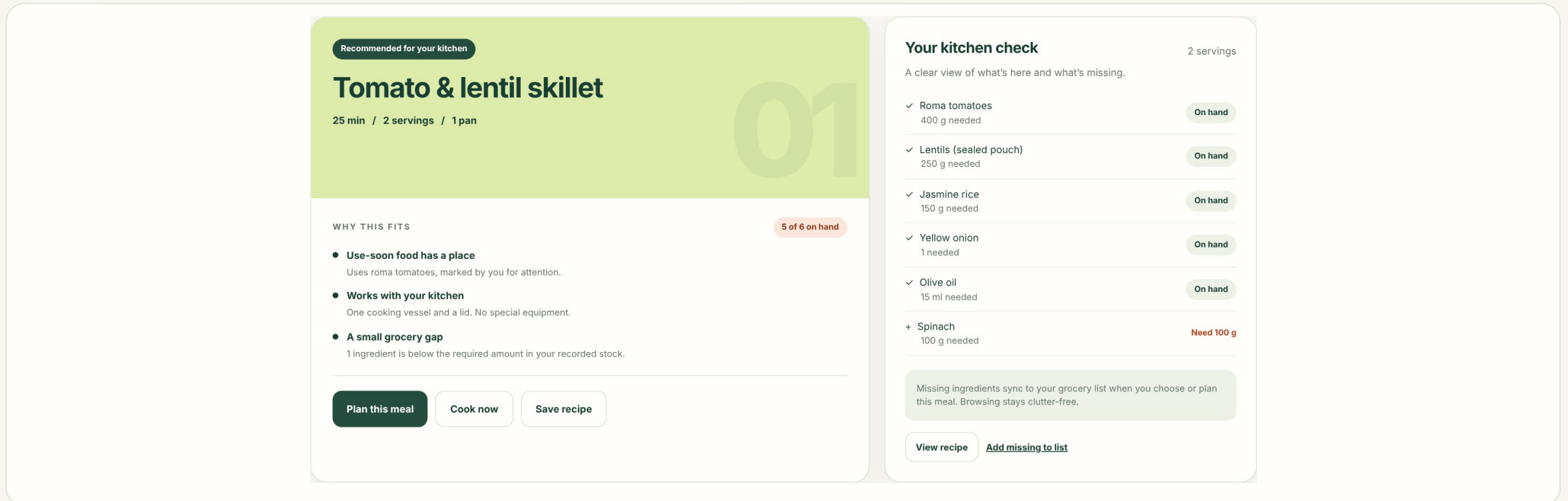
06

Cook, then keep the rest

Confirm actual ingredients used.
Save any uneaten portions as leftovers.

The AI should explain its recommendation.

A small set of relevant options beats an endless feed. Let the household see the tradeoffs.



01

Context before inspiration

Food, time, servings and equipment.

02

Reasons, not a mystery score

Use-soon food, effort, and missing items.

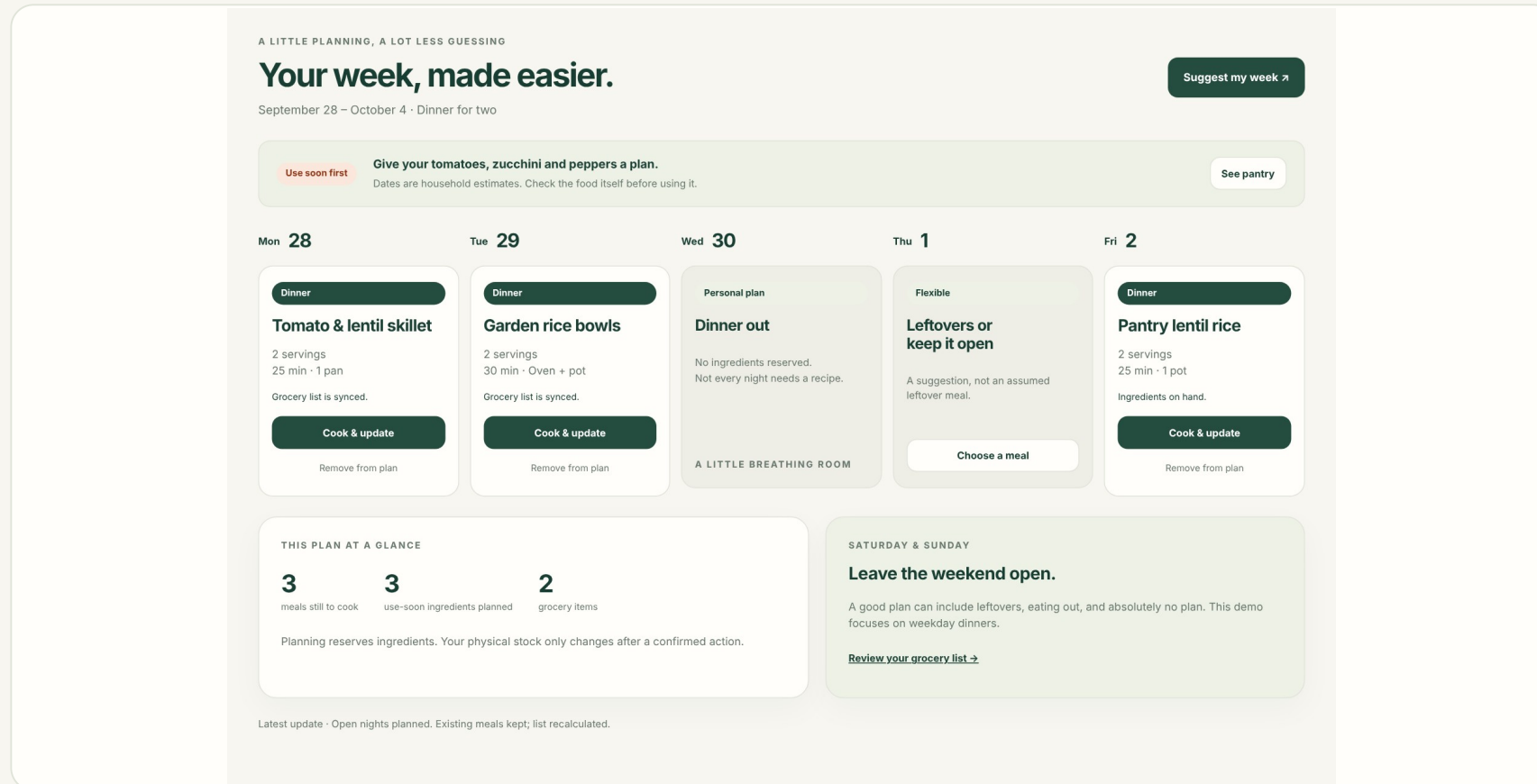
03

A choice that leads to action

Plan it, cook it, save it, or adapt it.

Plan enough. Leave room for life.

Batch the decisions without pretending every breakfast, lunch and dinner must be optimized.



01 / KEEP CONTROL

Fill empty slots. Keep locked meals.

Generate a proposal, then review it.
Do not silently replace plans the household already made.

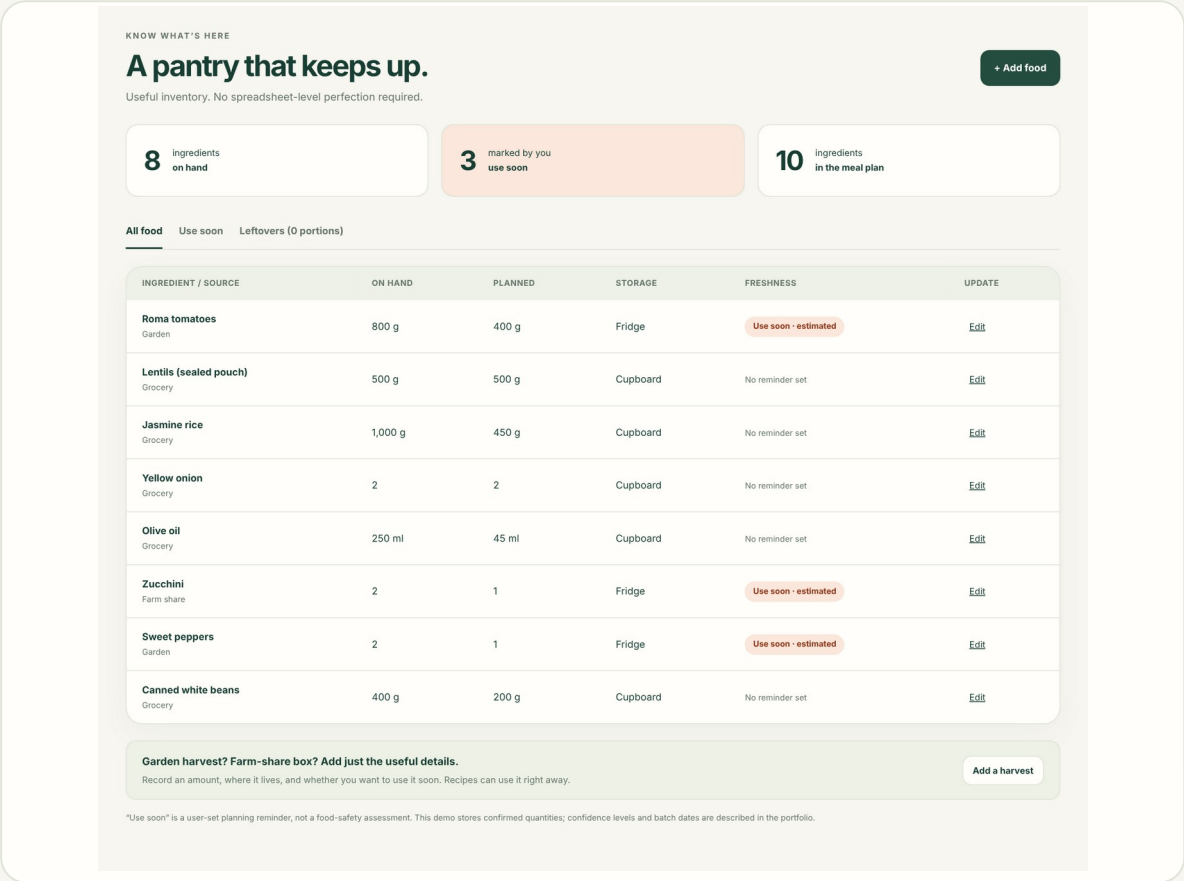
02 / SEE THE CONSEQUENCE

One edit updates the connected plan.

Rescale servings, swap a recipe, or
remove a meal. Reservations and
grocery needs follow.

Useful inventory, not another chore.

Accuracy matters. So does making correction easier than abandoning the system.



01

Keep the useful details

Amount, unit, storage, source, and freshness reminder. Add an opened date or batch only when it helps.

02

Show uncertainty honestly

Known, approximate, or unknown. "Unknown" is not "zero," and a reminder is not a food-safety verdict.

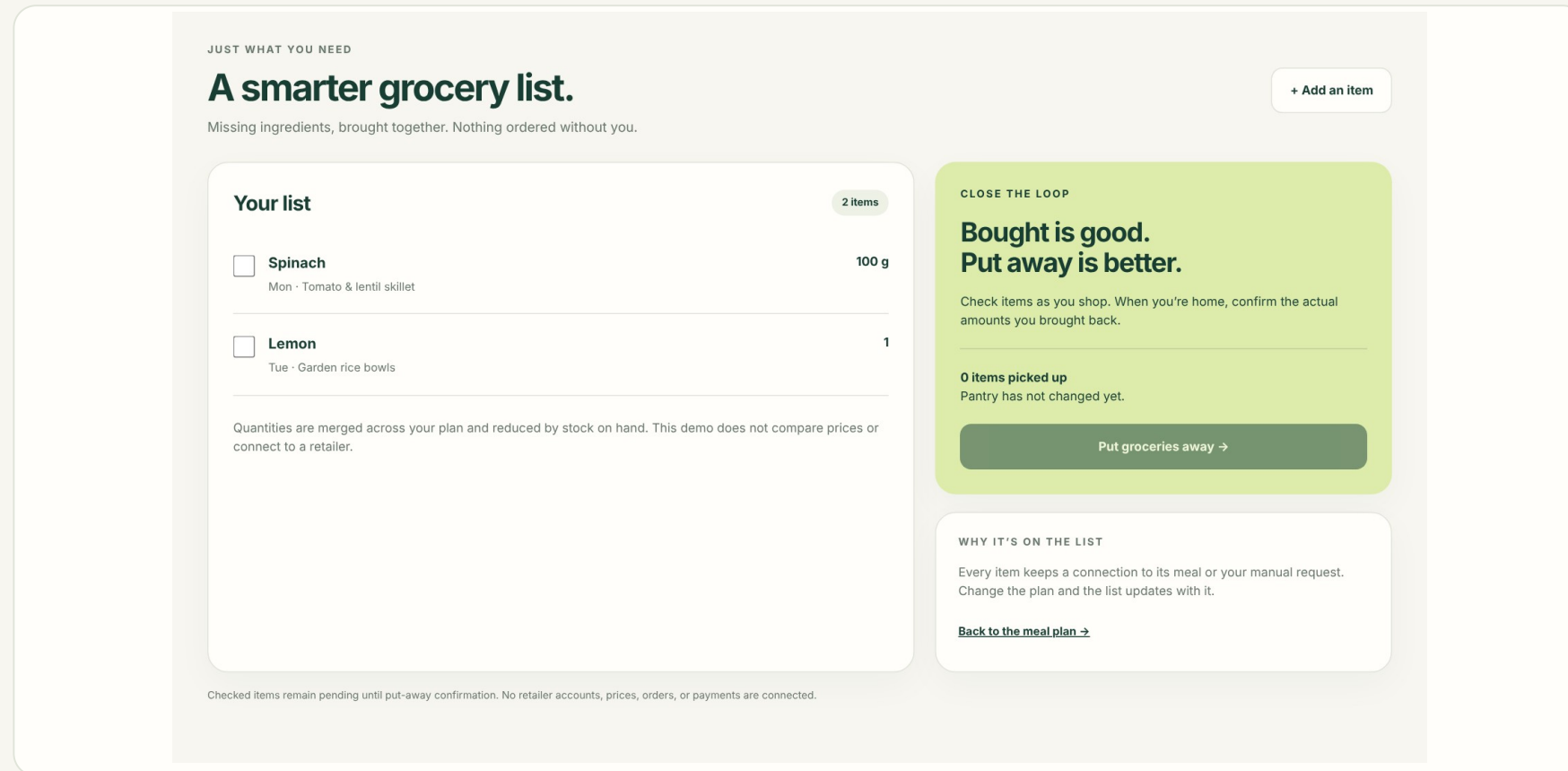
03

Make small updates effortless

Add a harvest, adjust a count, mark food used elsewhere, or record waste. Let the next plan adapt.

A list with a reason behind every item.

The list should feel simple in the store, even when the logic behind it is doing more work.



LESS MENTAL ARITHMETIC

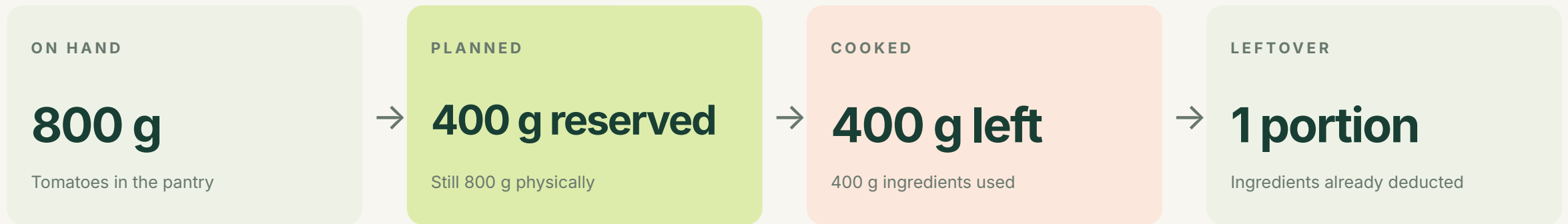
**Need 100 g.
Buy a 200 g bag.
Record 200 g.**

Check off while shopping.
Confirm quantities and
substitutions when putting
groceries away.

NO SILENT PURCHASES

Cooked is not the same as eaten.

Keep ingredients, reservations and prepared meals separate so food is never counted twice.



RULE 01

Plan or reschedule

Change reservations and shopping needs.
Do not change physical stock.

RULE 02

Cook or assemble a meal

Review actual use. Deduct ingredients.
Create the confirmed prepared portions.

RULE 03

Eat a leftover

Deduct a prepared portion only.
Do not deduct the recipe again.

Every change needs a reason, a preview when consequential, and an undo path. Shared-household writes must not apply twice.

Smart suggestions. Predictable consequences.

Use AI for interpretation and possibilities. Use explicit rules for quantities, constraints and actions.

THE HOUSEHOLD DEFINES

What matters

Hard constraints

Explicit allergies, dietary exclusions, equipment and non-negotiable limits.

Soft preferences

Taste, nutrition priorities, use-soon food, cost, variety, effort and cleanup.

THE AI PROPOSES

What could work

Generate and explain

Offer a few relevant meals and show what each option optimizes.

Adapt and learn

Use favorites and explicit feedback. Suggest substitutions for review.

THE PRODUCT ENFORCES

What changes

Deterministic accounting

Scale quantities, merge shopping needs, reserve stock and validate updates.

Human confirmation

Approve plans, imports, actual use and any eventual paid order.

Do not relax a hard constraint to improve a score. Do not infer allergy tolerance. Unknown ingredients or quantities require review.

Earn trust before asking for a complete pantry.

Get to a useful meal first. Grow the inventory and preferences through normal cooking.

01 Set the boundaries

People and servings, kitchen tools, hard dietary rules, and tonight's time limit.

02 Add a useful handful of food

Start with 5–10 ingredients, especially perishables. Pantry staples stay unconfirmed until checked.

03 Make one good decision

Choose a meal, review the gaps, and see the grocery list update automatically.

04 Build a kitchen that feels like yours

Save favorites, import your recipes, and give explicit “more like this” or “less like this” feedback.

A GENTLE FIRST RELEASE

**You don't need
a perfect pantry
to make a
good dinner.**

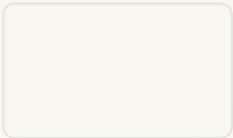
Prompt for small corrections
when they matter—not a
full inventory audit every week.

A calm kitchen companion.

Warm and practical—not a diet dashboard, an AI chat wrapper, or an enterprise inventory system.



Good food. Less friction.



PAPER



PANTRY



FRESH



USE SOON

TYPOGRAPHY

Inter / clear, warm, readable

Quiet confidence

Clear hierarchy, a few useful choices, and room to breathe.

Meaning before decoration

Explain the recommendation and the next action before showing a food photo.

Accessible by design

Visible keyboard focus, text labels beyond color, readable contrast, and generous touch targets.

Mobile everyday. Larger when helpful.

Shop and cook on a phone; plan a week comfortably on a larger screen.

Prove the kitchen loop before the integrations.

A broad vision is useful. A narrow first release makes it possible to test the hardest assumption.

01 / FIRST RELEASE

The core loop

- Manual pantry + garden intake
- Household preferences and tools
- Curated + AI-assisted recipe options
- Manual / pasted recipe entry and favorites
- Light weekly dinner planning
- One aggregated grocery list
- Confirm put-away, cooking and leftovers
- Corrections and undo

02 / LESS MAINTENANCE

Reduce the upkeep

- Shared-household sync
- Receipt and photo intake
- Reviewed URL / image recipe imports
- Inventory confidence and dated batches
- User-set staple replenishment prompts
- Farm-share manifests and garden feeds
- Deeper meal slots and batch prep

03 / CONNECT COMMERCE

Shop beyond the list

- Supported retailer connections
- Package and unit-price comparisons
- Availability-aware substitutions
- User-approved carts and checkout
- Fees and minimum-order visibility
- Coverage and commercial disclosures

Phase gates are learning goals, not committed dates. Do not build integrations to compensate for an unproven everyday habit.

The key risk is not recipe generation. It is upkeep.

Would people maintain enough context for LunchBox to keep earning its place in the kitchen?

PROPOSED NORTH-STAR METRIC

**Weekly meals
actually made
with LunchBox.**

Measure completed cooking actions per active household—not recipes generated or meals merely planned.

01

Can they get value before perfect setup?

Observe first-meal selection from a small, incomplete pantry.

02

Does the system remain believable?

Run a 14-day household pilot; inspect stock mismatches and corrections.

03

Does the plan survive real life?

Test skipped meals, substitutions, leftovers, eating out and shared use.

04

Is the result worth the effort?

Compare time spent deciding with time spent maintaining the system.

Guardrails: no silent constraint overrides, no unexplained stock changes, low correction burden, and user-controlled notifications.

Try the loop. Then build the smallest real version.

The interactive prototype demonstrates the connections—not live AI, nutrition, or retailer integrations.

IN THE INCLUDED HTML PROTOTYPE

Plan → Shop → Put away → Cook

1. Plan the tomato & lentil skillet for Monday.
2. Check spinach off the grocery list.
3. Put away 200 g, even though the recipe needs 100 g.
4. Cook two portions; record one as eaten now.
5. Eat the leftover later. Watch raw stock stay unchanged.

Also try: suggest a week, save a recipe, add garden food, correct an amount, and undo a change.

INTERACTIVE TODAY

Four connected views
Sample recipe library
Reservations and shopping math
Actual receipts, cooking and leftovers
Local browser state and undo

NOT CONNECTED

Live AI, nutrition calculation, recipe imports, cloud / household sync, price comparison, online ordering, and external inventory feeds.